PLAYBOOK · PALLETISATION

Pallet-first is a habit, not a project

From hand-loaded to pallet-first in 5 steps

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SUPPLY CHAIN 101 · PALLETISED DISPATCH RATE

Measure it in cases

- Rate = cases dispatched on pallets ÷ total cases dispatched
- Illustrative: 9,000 of 12,000 cases = 75%
- Count cases, not pallets, or hand-loading hides

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STEP 1 · BASELINE

Know your real starting point

- Track the rate daily, by shift and by route
- List which loads still go by hand, and why
- Set a monthly target the team can see

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STEP 2 · THE LOAD

Build pallets that fit the truck

- Standard patterns per SKU and pack
- Match pallet count to the truck bed
- Stretch wrap so loads survive the road

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STEP 3 · THE CUSTOMER

Agree how pallets get off

- Check each customer can receive pallets
- Plan pallet returns and swaps up front
- Keep hand-loading as the exception, logged

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STEP 4 · THE DOCK

Make pallet-first the default

- Pick and stage by pallet, not by case
- Train loaders and supervisors on the new SOP
- Review every hand-loaded truck next morning

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THE TAKEAWAY

Change the default, then track it daily

Save this for your next review.

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